

Your name:

The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2021

Round 2



Solution and marking.

Scoring: (max 51)

- Q5.1. (max 28)
 - A-D: 1 for each correct item separated by +. (max 10)
 - #A: accept *sit* for *sit down*
 - #A: accept *you(pl) your snake*
 - #B: accept *stand up* for *stand* – but not *are standing*
 - #B: accept *you(sg) ... you will...*
 - #C: accept *baby* for *child*.
 - #D: accept *down* for *to* – but not *will go* for *are going*
 - E-H: 1 for each completely correct word. No half marks. (max 18)
 - ignore hyphens in the solution below.
 - insist on correct order of words
- Q5.2. Assign marks as shown in the explanation (max 23)
 - Any solution which includes the correct information should be given marks, regardless of organisation.

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	Tawala	English
A	Apo onaduhuna babana motami igobu	You (pl) will sit down + because + your (pl) snake is dirty.
B	Inapa unatowolo apo unamae	If + you (sg) stand, + you (sg) will stay/be staying.
C	Tewela hidewadewa ma natum dewadewana	The children are (being) good + but + your (sg) child is (always) (being) good.
D	Unenae nu tahaya daodaona	You (sg) are going to the long path.
E	Ginouli bigabiga-na o-danena-ya	You (pl) steal a swampy thing.
F	Inapa tahaya i-na-dao apo u-na-gobu	If the path is long, you (sg) will be dirty.
G	Limi natu-na meme-na i-hilage ma ega hilhilage-na.	Limi's settled child is dying but is not dead.
H	Tewela daladala-hi ano-hi	The crawling children have substance.

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Commentary

How to solve it.

Most of the problem is fairly routine (e.g. the syntax and affixes). The main difficulty is the reduplication (doubling), which affects both verbs and equivalents of English adjectives, which we can treat as verbs in Tawala. However, the key is to draw up a table of how the reduplicated forms of verbs behave. At the foot of this explanation is an example of such a table showing all the verbs in the data classified according to whether they are reduplicated or not, and whether they have prefixes for the subject.

Explanation and mark scheme

Nouns. 4 marks

- Nouns are not marked for number. [1]
- They can be marked for possessor with a suffix: [1]

2s	-m
3s	-na
2p	-mi
3p	-hi [1 if all correct]

- Note that **natu** means *son/daughter*, so is always possessed; **tewela** means *child* more generally, so is not possessed. [1]

Verbs. 10 marks

- All verbs fall into one of two [in reality more] categories:
 - “active”, which here all have a sense of motion or activity: **towolo** *stand*, **dala** *crawl*, **danene** *steal*, **duhuna** *sit*, **nae** *go* [1 for idea, 2 for semantic difference OR list]
 - and “stative”, which describe a state: **hilage** *be dying*, **gobu** *be dirty*, **dao** *be long*, **mae** *be staying*, **dewadewa** *be (being) good*, **bigabiga** *be muddy* [1 for idea, 2 for semantic diff. OR list]
- All verbs have a reduplicated form. [0.5]
 - The reduplicated form is often not predictable (as can be seen in the table at the foot of the explanation). [0.5]
 - Two verbs, **bigabiga** and **dewadewa** are reduplicated in their basic form (where other verbs are unreduplicated) and they do not reduplicate further (where other verbs do). [1]
- Verbs mark their subject with a prefix and their object with a suffix [1], as follows:

2sg	u-	-m
3sg	i-	-ya
2pl	o-	-mi
3pl	hi-	-hi [1 if all correct]

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- The reduplicated form of an *active* verb may be used to indicate the durative aspect. [1]
- When a verb follows either **apo** or **inapa**, the verb takes **-na-** after the prefix. [1]
[This marks the potential mood.]

Adjectives. 4 marks

- Adjectives are derived from the reduplicated form of verbs. [1]
- Adjectives derived from stative verbs have a more permanent meaning than the root verb (e.g. *be muddy* > *swampy*, *be dying* > *dead*, *be staying* > *settled*). [1]
- They take a possessive suffix to agree with the noun they are modifying. [1]
- They can act as a predicate (where they still take a suffix to agree with the noun) but they cannot take **-na-**, so cannot co-occur with either **apo** or **inapa**. [1]

Syntax 5 marks

- The basic word order is SOV, but subject and object can be omitted if marked on the verb. [1]
- Two clauses can be linked by **ma** *and/but* or **babana** *because*, both standing after the first clause, or by **inapa** *if* standing before it. [0.5]
- Adjectives come directly after the noun they are modifying. [0.5]
- Possessed nouns are preceded by their possessors. [0.5]
- A noun N can be directly followed by a possessed noun N_P in predicate position to mean “N has N_P”. [0.5]
- **Ega** *not* precedes any part of the clause it is negating. [1]
- **Apo** *will* comes at the start of the clause. [0.5]
- **Nu** *to* precedes the noun. [0.5]

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single, prefixed			double, prefixed			double, suffixed		
#	form	meaning	#	form	meaning	#	form	meaning
2	o+ na +nae	you ... go	8	u+ na + <u>nen</u> ae	you are going			
1	u+hilage	you are dying				11	<u>hi</u> hilage+hi	are dead
9	u+ na +gobu	you ... be dirty				5	<u>gobu</u> gobu+hi	are stained
15	hi+gobu	they are dirty						
9	u+ na +peu	you fall				10	<u>pi</u> peu+na	falling
16	hi+peu	they fall						
10	i+mae	is staying				3	<u>me</u> me+hi	are settled
						12	<u>me</u> me+na	settled
14	i+ na +dao	it ... be long				11	<u>da</u> odao+hi	long
			13	i+ <u>to</u> wotowolo	he is standing	16	<u>to</u> wotowolo+hi	standing
			1	o+ na + <u>dewa</u> dewa a	you ... be good	7	<u>dewa</u> dewa+na	good
			2	o+ <u>da</u> ladala	you are crawling	15	<u>da</u> ladala+na	crawling
			14	i+ <u>bi</u> gabiga	is muddy	5	<u>bi</u> gabiga+na	swampy
13 ,1 5	o+gale+ya i+gale+mi	you see him he sees you (pl)						
8	hi+ na +pani+m	they imprison you (sg)						
			6	hi+ <u>du</u> huhuna	they are sitting down			
			7	i+ <u>da</u> nedanene+ hi	is stealing them			